GGG-D-326c
March 26, 1964

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GGG-D-326b (GSA-FSS), April 29, 1963 and
Fed. Spec. GGG-D-326, May 20, 1942

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

DIGGER; POSTHOLE, HINGED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers posthole diggers suitable for digging postholes in all kinds of heavy and gravel soils.

1.1.1 *Federal specification coverage.* Federal specifications do not include all varieties of the commodity as indicated by the title of the specification, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover only those generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Sizes.* The posthole diggers covered by this specification shall be of the following sizes as specified (see 6.1):

Size 1.—Four-foot handles (see table I).
Size 2.—Seven-foot handles (see table I).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specification:

NN-H-81—Handles, Ash, for Tools.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151—Metals, Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-H-15424—Hand Tools Packaging of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

FSC 5120

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 **Design.** Each posthole digger shall consist essentially of two handles and two blades fastened to two frame sections that are hinged together. The bore diameter of each digger shall be not less than 5 inches.

3.1.1 *Blades and frame sections.* Blades shall be of high grade steel not less than 0.079 inch thick after the enamel, paint, or lacquer has been removed from a spot on both surfaces for measuring by micrometer. Blades shall be scoop shaped, each blade being securely riveted to a malleable iron or steel frame. One end of each frame shall project upward to form a socket or channel for securing the handle. The other end of the frame shall be equipped with a lug or lugs for hinging the frame sections together. Each blade shall be not less than 4-1/2 inches in curved width and not less than 9 inches in depth. The hardness of each blade shall be not less than Rockwell C-10.

3.1.2 *Hinge.* The two frame sections of the digger shall be hinged on the frame lugs by a bolt passing through the lugs. The bolt shall be not less than 3/8-inch nominal diameter.

3.1.3 *Handles.* Handles shall be thoroughly seasoned ash in accordance with grade SB in NN-H-81. Each handle shall be securely fastened to the frame by at least two bolts with washers and nuts. Bolts shall be not less than 1/4-inch in diameter and shall extend through the handle. Handles shall be not less than 1-3/16 inches in diameter at the grip end and not less than 1-1/4 inches square at the socket end.

3.1.4 *Stop(s).* One or more stops shall be provided for the purpose of keeping the blades in digging position.

3.2 **Examination and test requirements.** The posthole diggers shall comply with the examination and test requirements in section 4.

3.3 **Finish.** Handles shall have a waxed, varnished, or lacquered finish. Blades and frame shall be enameled, painted, or lacquered.

3.4 **Marking.** Each posthole digger shall be marked in a plain and permanent manner with the manufacturer's name or with a trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.5 **Illustration.** The illustration shown herein is for the purpose of identification and is not intended to preclude the purchase of posthole diggers which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.6 Sizes. Posthole diggers (figure 1) shall conform to the requirements of table I for the applicable size(s) specified in the invitation for bids.

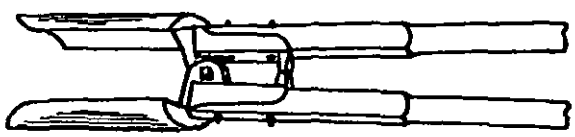


FIGURE 1.—Digger, posthole.

TABLE I.—*Dimensional and weight requirements*

Size	Handle length[1] (nominal)	Overall length (minimum)	Weight	
			Minimum	Maximum
Number	*Feet*	*Inches*	*Pounds*	*Pounds*
1	4	58	8-1/2	12
2	7 or 8	94	12	14

[1] At the option of the manufacturer, the nominal length of handles for size 2 diggers may be either 7 or 8 feet.

3.7 **Workmanship.** Workmanship shall be first class in every respect.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for acceptance inspection.

4.2.1 *Inspection lot.* All diggers of the same type and size offered for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of sampling and tests.

4.2.2 *Sampling for visual and dimensional examination.* A random sample of diggers shall be selected from each inspection lot of material offered for examination of visual and dimensional characteristics with lot acceptance based on the sampling inspection requirements in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be level II with an AQL of 1.5 percent defective.

4.2.3 *Sampling for tests.* A random sample of diggers shall be selected from each inspection lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105 at inspection level S-4 and shall be subjected to the test specified in 4.4.1. The acceptable quality level shall be equal to 4.0 percent defective.

4.3 Examination. Each of the sample diggers selected in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined to verify compliance with this specification. Examination shall be made to determine if the handles have been properly and tightly fitted. Examinations shall be conducted as specified in table II. Any digger in the sample that fails to pass the examination of 4.3. or the tests of 4.4.1 and 4.4.2 shall be rejected, and if the number of defective diggers in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE II.—*Classification of defects*

Categories	Defects
Critical:	None defined.
Major:	
101	Size not as specified (see 1.2.1 and table I).
102	Bore diameter less than 5-inches (see 3.1).
103	Blades not of thickness specified (see 3.1.1).
104	Blades not securely fastened to frame (see 3.1.1).
105	Blades less than 4-1/2-inches curved width or less than 9 inches deep (see 3.1.1).
106	Hinge bolt less than 3/8-inch nominal diameter (see 3.1.2).
107	Handle not of grade specified (see 3.1.3).
108	Handles not securely fastened (see 3.1.3).
109	Handle bolts less than 1/4-inch diameter (see 3.1.3).
110	Handle cross-sections too small (see 3.1.3).
111	Stop(s) not provided (see 3.1.4).
112	Weight not as specified (see table I).
Minor:	
201	Finish not as specified (see 3.3).
202	Marking not as specified (see 3.4).
203	Workmanship not first class (see 3.7).
204	Preparation for delivery not as specified (see 4.3.1).

4.3.1 *Examination of preparation for delivery.* An examination shall be made to determine compliance with preservation, packaging, packing, and marking requirements in accordance with section 5 and MIL-H-15424.

4.4 Test procedures

4.4.1 *Physical test.* A block of wood or other suitable object shall be inserted between the blades of the digger at a point

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4-1/2 (+ 1/2) inches from the cutting edge. The width or diameter of the block shall be approximately the perpendicular distance between opposite edges of the blades when in driving (parallel) position. A total force of 150 pounds (75 pounds on each handle) shall be applied at points 36 inches from the center line of the hinge bolt for the size 1 digger and 60 inches from the center line of the hinge bolt for the size 2 digger. Each 75-pound force shall be applied perpendicular to the handle and directly opposite one another so that the combined 150 pounds forces the handles apart and the blades together. The load shall be applied for 120 (+ 5) seconds. The sample digger shall not rupture, take permanent set, or otherwise become defective as a result of this test.

4.4.2 *Hardness test.* Each blade of sample diggers shall be tested for hardness to determine compliance with 3.1.1, in accordance with Fed. Test Method Std. No. 151.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(Civil agencies should refer to Fed. Std. No. 102 for definitions and application of the various levels of packaging protection for supplies and equipment.)

5.1 Preservation and packaging.

5.1.1 *Level A.* Level A cleaning, preservation and packaging shall be in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424.

5.1.2 *Level C.* Level C cleaning, preservation and packaging shall be in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 *Level A.* Level A packing shall be in accordance with level A of MIL-H-15424.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Level B. packing shall be in accordance with level B of MIL-H-15424.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Posthole diggers cleaned, preserved, and packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with rules or regulations of carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, each unit and intermediate package and shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size required (see table I).
(c) Level of preservation, packaging, and packing required (see section 5).
(d) Special marking, if required (see 5.3).

6.2 Transportation description. Transportation description and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Posthole diggers
Carload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:

Posthole diggers
Truckload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—GL

Navy—Docks

Air Force—MOA

Preparing Activity:

GSA—FSS

☆ U.S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE: 1964—703388/888

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.